

CAN YOU GET PREGNANT DURING PERIMENOPAUSE?

Yes – And Here's Why

Many people believe perimenopause means fertility has already ended. That's a myth.

During perimenopause, hormone levels fluctuate and ovulation can still occur unpredictably. This means pregnancy is still possible.

You are only considered menopausal after **12 consecutive months without a period**.

Busting Perimenopause Pregnancy Myths

Myth 1: Irregular periods mean you can't get pregnant

Fact: Ovulation may still occur even when cycles are irregular. Hormone fluctuations can sometimes cause multiple ovulations in a cycle, increasing the chance of twins.

Myth 2: A blood test can predict menopause

Fact: There is no reliable hormone test that can accurately predict menopause because hormone levels fluctuate greatly during perimenopause.

Myth 3: Pregnancy in your 40s is too unlikely to worry about

Fact: Fertility declines, but it does not disappear.

Average chance of pregnancy per month:

- Early 40s: about 10%
- Late 40s: 2–3%
- Around age 50: <1%

However, risks increase with age:

- Miscarriage
- Gestational diabetes

- High blood pressure
- Chromosomal conditions

Myth 4: You can stop using birth control after 40

Fact: Contraception should continue until menopause is confirmed.
Irregular cycles make natural family planning unreliable.

Myth 5: Birth control and hormone therapy are the same

Fact: They are different treatments.

- Birth control: often contains ethinyl estradiol
- Hormone therapy (HRT): uses estradiol in safer forms like patches or gels

Contraception Options During Perimenopause

Some options may also help manage symptoms.

- **Progestin IUD**
Helps prevent pregnancy and reduce heavy bleeding
- **Progestin pills or estrogen patches**
Often recommended for individuals with high blood pressure or those who smoke
- **Permanent options**
Tubal ligation or vasectomy

Speak with a healthcare provider to find the best option for you.

Key Takeaway

Pregnancy becomes less common, but it is **still possible during perimenopause**.

Continue using contraception until you have gone
12 consecutive months without a period

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

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<https://www.uhhospitals.org/blog/articles/2025/08/can-you-get-pregnant-during-perimenopause>